

Backup and restore

Brayman Construction. Mac office. 7 October 2026.

Joel does this. Ben does not.

The office is one file: instance/brayman_estimator.db in the Brayman-Estimator folder. There is no automatic backup. A copy is not finished until the check says ok and a second copy exists outside that live file.

Do this before the first real project is typed in, at the end of any day a real project changed, and before any change to the office file's structure. Ben never makes that structure change.

Backup

1. Tell Ben to stop entering work.
2. Stop the office. In the terminal where it is running, press Control-C.
3. Do not run a database upgrade.
4. From the Brayman-Estimator folder, run:

```
mkdir -p instance/backups
sqlite3 instance/brayman_estimator.db ".backup 'instance/backups/brayman-office-YYYY-MM-DD-HHMM.db'"
sqlite3 instance/backups/brayman-office-YYYY-MM-DD-HHMM.db "PRAGMA integrity_check; SELECT version_num FROM alembic_version;"
```

5. The check must print ok, then one revision line. On 7 October 2026 the live file's revision was h8c9d0e1f2a3.
 6. Copy that same backup file to a second place that is not the live office file and not only instance/backups. Write that place in the backup log the first time you use it.
 7. Add one line to docs/operations/v1-backup-log.md: date, file name, ok, the revision line, the second-copy place, and your name.
- instance/ is not in git. The backup log is. Do not commit the database file.

Restore

1. Stop the office. Do not start it if instance/brayman_estimator.db is missing. Starting it can create an empty office.
2. Rename the current file. Do not delete it. Example: instance/brayman_estimator.unusable-YYYY-MM-DD-HHMM.db. Move brayman_estimator.db-wal and brayman_estimator.db-shm aside too, if they are there.
3. Copy the chosen backup onto instance/brayman_estimator.db.
4. Run the same integrity check. It must print ok and a revision line.
5. Start the office the same way: from the Brayman-Estimator folder, flask run.
6. Sign in and open the project. If it is missing, stop. Do not type it in again on a blank office.
7. Write the restore in the backup log.

If the office is unusable

Stop. Do not create a new database. Do not run an upgrade to fix it. Do not keep typing. Restore from the last line in the backup log whose check said ok.